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Speech Scripts

Title:
Pinocchio: No Strings Attached

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Published by
MUSHROOM CLOUD PRESS
Portland, OR

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Pinocchio: No Strings Attached

By Joseph Lynn and Brian Sams

Gepetto: Stereotypical Italian Grandfather Type.
Figaro: A Cat.
Cleo: A Fish. Gold.
Blues Fairy: A fairy that plays The Blues.
Pinocchio: A wooden-headed boy.
Jiminy Cricket: Pinocchio's Chaperone.
Lampwick: A Skeezy Character.
Monstro: The Whale.

Gepetto: Hello-a, my name-a is-a Gepetto. I live-a with-a my cat-a Figaro (cut to Figaro, who meows) and-a my-a goldfish Cleo (Cut to Cleo, who does something fishy). But-a what would-a make me-a truly happy is a real-a boy. Too bad I'm-a no good-a with the women, eh? Oh well. Anyway, take a look at-a this. It's-a Pinocchio. Eh? Okay, so it's-a just a puppet. Oh my! Look, it's a wishing star. Star-a-light, star-a- bright, first-a-star I see-a- tonight, (Deep Breath), I wish I may, I wish I might have a blue fairy come down in the middle of the night and-a magically make Pinocchio come to life. Then, I wish for the blue fairy to send him on a quest where he finds his-a true identity, and eventually turns into a real boy. But, oh well, I doubt-a this will ever happen. Goodnight-a, Pinocchio.

SCENE

Blues Fairy:(Guitar riff) Pinocchio, get on up!

Pinocchio: Whoa, what the...hey I'm alive. Hey, who are you?

Blues Fairy: I'm the Blues Fairy!

Pinocchio: Don't you mean Blue Fairy?

Blues Fairy: Nah, I mean blues fairy, 'cuz I gots the blues. (Extended blues riff)

Pinocchio: Okay, well, I'll see you later.

Blues Fairy: Wait a minute, Pinocchio. I have to tell you something. You are not a real boy, and you will not become a real boy until you prove yourself worthy. Once you are able to determine right from wrong on your own, only then will you become a real boy.

Pinocchio: Well, how am I supposed to determine right from wrong?

Blues Fairy: You will receive help from this noble cricket, whose name is Jiminy.

Jiminy Cricket: Why, why, why hello there. (ala Jimmy Stewart)

Pinocchio: A cricket? Aw, a dragon would've been a lot cooler.

Blues Fairy: Jiminy Cricket, you will help Pinocchio become a real boy by acting as his conscience.

Jiminy Cricket: Well, that's not right, your conscience isn't in a cricket. It's in Joe's house and that's next to the Kennedy house and Mrs. Makelin's house and a hundred others. Aww, forget it.

Blues Fairy: Goodbye Pinocchio. Remember; always let your conscience be your guide.

Gepetto: What-a in-a the wide-a, wide-a world of sports is a-going on-a here?

Pinocchio: Excuse me, who are you?

Gepetto: Pinocchio, you're alive! It's a me-a, Gepetto! I'm-a your-a father. Finally, I have a boy-a of my own! ...And now it's-a time-a for you-a to go to school.

Pinocchio: School! What's school Jiminy?

Jiminy Cricket: Why school's a wonderful place where you'll learn many useful skills and important information.

Pinocchio: Well, if you say it's good then it must be good. Let's go.Whoa! (Nose grows rapidly) Jiminy, what's happening?

Jiminy Cricket: Your nose is growing!

Blues Fairy: (Blues riff, then as if singing a song.) Pinocchio, don't you know, anytime you don't make your own decisions your nose is going to grow…

Pinocchio: Wow. You should really stick to magic.

Blues Fairy: You can't just go with the flow, You got to be your own man, man, you dig?

Pinocchio: Yeah, I dig. Whaaa? Hey, my nose grew again! What's the deal?

Blues Fairy: Yeah, it might do that if you lie, too.

Pinocchio: Aww, Jiminy Cricket!

Jiminy Cricket: Wha, wha, what, Pinocchio?

Pinocchio: HMMMPH! Not now, Jiminy! Okay, okay, Pinocchio, I need to make my own decision, here... Jiminy says school is great... Blues Fairy?

Blues Fairy: It's aight.

Pinocchio: Gepetto?

Gepetto: I'm a justa stereotypical decrepit Italian a-grandfather type. What am I-a going to do-a with-a you? You wish-a on-a one a-little star, and all-a of a sudden, I'm a some-a kind of expert?

Pinocchio: Okay, then, I think I'll go to school. (Checks nose.) Yes!

Blues Fairy: Well that’s what you got to do. Now I’m going to split. You bests go to school, peace!

Pinocchio: I've got no strings
To hold me down
To make me fret
Or make me frown
I had strings
But now I'm free
There are no strings on me!

Lampwick: Hey, kid what’s your name?

Pinocchio: My name’s Pinocchio, and I'm going to school!

Lampwick: Hey Pinocchio, my name’s Lampwick, and let me tell you, school’s for geeks. Come with me to a place a lot more fun than school.

Pinocchio: Oh Boy! We’re going to Hooters?

Lampwick: Close, but no. No, kid, Pleasure Island. It’s a place where kids can do whatever they want, so come with me.

Pinocchio: Okay. Jiminy what should I do?

Jiminy Cricket: Well, you should stay in school!

Pinocchio: Okay. Uh huh, uh huh. Hmm, the Blues Fairy said I had to make my own decisions so... I think I’ll go to Pleasure Island! (Nose doesn't grow) Solid!

Lampwick: Here we are kid, Pleasure Island, now you'll drink beer and play pool.

Pinocchio: Okay. Dangit, wait one doggone minute. Aren't I a little young to be drinking beer?

Jiminy Cricket: You most certainly are young man. The legal drinking age... and the effects on your developing brain...I, I…

Pinocchio: Fine, fine, fine. I pass on the beer.

Lampwick: I can see you have a strong independent streak kid, have a cigarette then. All the strong, independent, rebellious types who don't like to be told what to do smoke cigarettes.

Pinocchio: Why?

Lampwick: Because advertisers tell them to.

Pinocchio: Seems legit. Okaaaay...wait a minute. Jiminy, what's up with these cigarettes?

Jiminy Cricket: Why cigarettes are awful. Smoking causes lung cancer and emphysema and heart disease just for starters. They're evil! Plain evil!

Pinocchio: Evil cigarettes, huh? Well, I think I'll pass. (Nose doesn't grow.) Wow, I'm getting this thing down!

Lampwick: You don't know what you're missing, kid. Keep ahold of the cigarettes in case you change your mind and want to do something bold and original like millions of others.

Pinocchio: Okay. Hey Jiminy, I think it's getting a little late for school, let's just get outta this rotten joint and go home! (Over shoulder in order to be overheard by Lampwick) At least I've heard Hooters has excellent french fries!

Jiminy Cricket: Well, I suppose, as long as we abide by all traffic laws and and cross only in designated pedestrian crosswalks…

Pinocchio: Oh, yeah, cuz jaywalking is tearing this country apart....(Musical transition, humming or singing “No Strings Attached.”) Hey, Jiminy, look! Gepetto's not home. He left a note. It says, “Went a-looking for-a Pinocchio. Got a-trapped in a whale's a-stomach. Fix a-dinner. I'll be-a home-a-late.” Why, we have to save him! Hey! There's a huge whale right there. That's pretty convenient. Maybe we can swim out to him.

Jiminy Cricket: Well I suppose we could, I mean it’s been an hour since we last ate and I don’t see any no swimming signs, but where’s the lifeguard?

Pinocchio: Jiminy, let’s just go.

(Pinocchio dives into the water and swims up to the whale.)

Excuse me, mister whale, can you please open your mouth?

Monstro: Mwaaaah. (Whale opens mouth.)

Pinocchio: Thank you, much obliged. Gepetto! Gepetto! (His calls echo through the whale.)

Gepetto: Pinocchio, where-a were you? You didn’t come-a home after-a school-a.

Pinocchio: Well see, I was going to school, and then I met this nice stranger named Lampwick, and he gave me beer and cigarettes, and I have some cigarettes and they’re right here.

Gepetto: Oh,no, Pinocchio that’s-a terrible.

Jiminy Cricket: That’s what I said,but he...

Pinocchio: Well, really it’s not that bad, I didn’t drink anything and I didn’t inhale. And I learned how to make my own decisions, so let’s get out of this whale and go on home.

Gepetto: No, Pinocchio, I am-a sorry. There’s-a no escaping-a Monstro the whale.

Pinocchio: Oh, I wish we could get out of this whale. I wish we could get out of this whale!

Blues Fairy: (Blues riff) Pinocchio, Gepetto, dig this! Even though Blues Fairies can do all kinds of magical shenanigans, we can't get people out of whales…. Maybe you can make Monstro sneeze you out.

Pinocchio: Why, that’s a wonderful idea there Blues Fairy.

Blues Fairy: Yeah, I'm flippin' full of em, and stop wishing so much, I’m a busy man, peace.

Jiminy Cricket: Do you see Pinoke?(Singing.)”When you wish upon a star…”

Pinocchio: Geez, Jiminy that song kinda gets on my nerves. Hey, I have an idea, those cigarettes that Lampwick gave me... they have a warning on the side that smoking causes severe hacking and sneezing. Maybe we can generate enough smoke to make Monstro sneeze us out?

Jiminy Cricket: No Pinoke, you can’t use those cigarettes. You’re obviously a victim of peer pressure here and…

Pinocchio: Well, I’m not going to smoke them Jiminy, I’m just using them to save our lives.

Jiminy Cricket:I still can’t condone this travesty. The second hand smoke would seriously hurt this already endangered whale! You've got the environment to think of, plus what kind of example will you be to Figaro?

Figaro: Meow.

Pinocchio: But Jiminy I...I was just...C'mon Pinocchio, let it go. Let it go, let it go, I am one with the wind and sky… Nope. Not working. Ahhh! (He stomps Jiminy into smithereens.)

Gepetto: You stomped-a poor-a Jiminy.

Pinocchio: Well I guess I did. But he was always telling me what to do without weighing the circumstances.

Gepetto: What a brave-a little cricket he was.

Pinocchio: Brave? I don't know, but he sure had a lot of guts! Ha! Too soon? … (Adopts a confident, self-righteous tone.) Anyway, I didn't actually kill Jiminy since he was just a physical manifestation of my undeveloped and legalistic conscience. So I guess you could say that no animals were hurt in the filming of this presentation.

Gepetto: No. I'm-a pretty sure-a he was a real-a cricket.

Pinocchio: (Looks at the bottom of his shoe.) Oh. Oh. Oh Yeah. Yeah, he was real, alright. I guess I kinda rushed into that one…But, hey, I'm talking to a guy who got swallowed by whale and had his cat and goldfish along, and that's pretty messed up... (Back to self righteous tone again.) But Jiminy will always live on in our hearts and souls (Looking at the sole of one of his shoes.)...of my shoe. Now let's spark these heaters! (Lights cigarettes. Inhales huge breath of smoke) Oh, gahh, that is really awful, why would anyone ever do that to their... Hey! It's working!

Monstro: Ah, Ah, Ah, Ahchoooo! (Whale sneezes them out.)

Pinocchio: (Flies out of the whale's mouth) Whaaaa! And he sticks the landing!

Gepetto: Wow, Pinocchio, you saved-a my life-a.

Pinocchio: Gosh it was nothing... On second thought and after careful consideration, I have reflected and decided that I would like to have another cigarette.

Gepetto: A really? Is-a that-a what you truly want-a?

Pinocchio: No, I guess not, the long term health and financial.... Hey, what's going on? What's going on? What's going on? (Break dancing moves.)

Gepetto: Pinocchio, what-a happened?

Pinocchio: I don't know. I'm not made of wood anymore. I'm a real boy, I'm a real boy. Woo hoo! Got to love you… (Michael Jacksonesque dance moves.)

Gepetto: He's a real boy. He's a real boy!

Pinocchio: I'm a real boy! It's just like the Blues Fairy said! I learned how to make my own decisions and determine right from wrong. I also learned that smoking is bad, unless you're inside of a whale.

Gepetto: Oh Pinocchio, my boy!